

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION (COMBINED TECHNICAL) FOR
RECRUITMENT TO THE POSTS OF AGRICULTURE & ALLIED SERVICES,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(NOVEMBER-2025)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

SECTION - A (Conventional Type) (50 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it.*

1. Write a Precis of the given passage, condensing it to approximately one third of the original length and give a title for the same. (15)

Morality constitutes the invisible framework that upholds the ethical foundation of any society, governing the conduct of individuals and shaping the collective conscience of a civilization. It transcends mere legality or convention, embodying the intrinsic sense of right and wrong that determines the moral tenor of human interactions. A society's moral fabric is neither static nor universal; it evolves in response to cultural, religious, and philosophical influences, reflecting the values and principles its people deem essential for harmonious coexistence. Without a moral compass to guide human behaviour, even the most sophisticated social structures risk descending into chaos and ethical decay.

The vitality of morality lies in its capacity to generate mutual trust and social cohesion. Moral principles such as honesty, compassion, integrity, and justice serve as the cornerstones of cooperative living, enabling individuals to interact with respect and empathy. When citizens adhere to shared ethical norms, society achieves a sense of unity and purpose greater than the sum of its parts. Conversely, when morality erodes under the pressure of materialism, corruption, or moral relativism, social divisions deepen, and institutions lose their legitimacy. In this sense, morality functions as both the glue and the safeguard of civilization.

Throughout history, moral thought has been shaped by various philosophical traditions and religious doctrines. From the Aristotelian notion of virtue ethics to Kant's categorical imperative and the utilitarian emphasis on the greatest good for the greatest number, thinkers have sought to define the basis of moral responsibility. These philosophical foundations continue to influence modern ethical discourse, guiding laws, education, and interpersonal relations. Despite cultural diversity, the universal aspiration toward moral goodness underscores humanity's innate desire for justice and compassion, attesting to the moral continuity that binds civilizations across time and geography.

In contemporary society, advances in technology, globalization, and social media have posed new moral dilemmas that challenge traditional ethical frameworks. Issues such as data privacy, artificial intelligence, climate responsibility, and social inequality demand a reevaluation of moral standards in light of modern complexity. The pace of change often outstrips the development of moral consensus, leaving individuals and institutions grappling with ambiguous ethical choices. As a result, the need for moral reflection and education becomes ever more urgent, not merely as a social requirement but as a condition for the preservation of human dignity in an increasingly impersonal world.

Ultimately, morality serves as the spiritual and ethical compass of society, directing collective progress toward justice and human flourishing. It reminds individuals that true advancement lies not only in material prosperity but in the cultivation of virtue and the pursuit of truth. A morally grounded society fosters empathy over exploitation, fairness over greed, and altruism over selfish ambition. When guided by moral integrity, civilization ascends beyond mere survival to achieve a higher form of human excellence—one in which wisdom, virtue, and conscience define the essence of progress.

2. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

Economic inequality, a condition deeply entrenched in many modern societies, has become a pressing concern for both policymakers and scholars. This imbalance, evident in the unequal allocation of wealth and resources, frequently intensifies social divisions and poses substantial obstacles to fair access to opportunities. Such widespread disparity undermines the core pillars of social unity, making the goal of shared prosperity ever more difficult to achieve.

Over time, a multitude of factors have driven economic inequality, ranging from colonial exploitation and uneven globalization to unpredictable fiscal policies. These historical influences have combined to create entrenched socioeconomic structures in which the affluent elite hold excessive sway over political and economic decisions. As a consequence, marginalized populations are often consigned to living in subsistence conditions, deprived of vital infrastructural resources.

In contemporary contexts, technological advancement and capital markets have paradoxically fostered both unprecedented growth and deepening inequality. The ascendancy of automation, though ostensibly designed to enhance efficiency, has often displaced swathes of the labour force, thereby aggravating unemployment rates. At the same time, the expansion of speculative investment opportunities has further benefited individuals with existing wealth, deepening the divide between the rich and the poor.

One cannot overlook the insidious ramifications of economic inequality on democratic institutions. When affluence confers outsized political leverage, public policy risks becoming skewed towards the preservation of privilege rather than the redress of injustice. This distortion undermines the legitimacy of governance, fostering cynicism amongst the disenfranchised and imperiling societal stability.

Addressing economic inequality necessitates a multifaceted approach encompassing progressive taxation, expansive educational access, and robust social welfare mechanisms. Reforms must transcend mere palliative measures, aspiring instead towards the dismantlement of entrenched inequities. Only through such deliberate and comprehensive intervention may societies envisage a future wherein prosperity is both shared and sustainable.

- (a) Define 'economic inequality' as portrayed in the passage. (2)
 - (b) Identify two historical factors mentioned that have contributed to economic disparity. (2)
 - (c) Explain how automation has paradoxically affected economic inequality. (2)
 - (d) Find the antonym of the word 'temporary' from the passage. (1)
 - (e) Find the synonym of the word 'wealthy' from the passage. (1)
 - (f) Make sentences using the word 'overlook' both as a noun and as a verb. (1+1=2)
3. You are **XYZ**, a resident of ABC Veng, Aizawl. You are disturbed by the poor maintenance as well as the dilapidated condition of the recently constructed and inhabited AMC Multi Complex located at Tuikual. Write a complaint letter to the Municipal Commissioner, Aizawl Municipal Corporation to take necessary actions regarding the same. (10)

4. Change the sentences as directed. (10×1=10)

- (a) The soldier was shot for inciting his comrades to rise against their officers. (Convert the sentence into a Complex Sentence)
- (b) He climbed up the tree and plucked some mangoes. (Convert the sentence into a Simple sentence)
- (c) In spite of having worked hard, yet he failed. (Convert the sentence into a Compound sentence)
- (d) A lemon tastes sour. (Change the voice)
- (e) Bitter experiences in life have soured the old man. (Change the voice)
- (f) Let the poor not be teased. (Change the voice)
- (g) People believe that the robber has worked in the bank. (Change the voice)
- (h) Sam's father said, "My son was ill." (Change the speech)
- (i) John said, "Goodbye my friends!" (Change the speech)
- (j) He said, "Leave the room and do not return here." (Change the speech)

5. Transform the sentences as directed. (5×1=5)

- (a) Can a leopard change his spots? (Transform the sentence into an Assertive sentence)
- (b) Nobody else could have done it. (Transform the sentence into an interrogative sentence)
- (c) She was asked not to loiter in the gallery. (Transform the sentence into an Affirmative sentence)
- (d) Every rose has a thorn. (Transform the sentence into a Negative sentence)
- (e) Was any man ever immortal? (Transform the sentence into an assertive sentence)

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice questions) (50 Marks)

*All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.
This Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Notes regarding Negative Marking :

- (i) There will be penalty (negative marking) for every wrong answer given by a candidate in the MCQ type questions.
 - (ii) For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, one-third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty
 - (iii) If a candidate gives more than one answer to one question, it will be treated as a wrong answer even if any one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above for that question.
 - (iv) If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.
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Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 10): Identify the Parts of speech of the underlined words in the given sentences:

1. The chef tasted the soup before adding salt.
(a) Noun (b) Pronoun
(c) Conjunction (d) Preposition
2. Jane always cries.
(a) Noun (b) Adverb
(c) Preposition (d) Adjective
3. Although Mary and Jerry love to dance, they hardly have time for it.
(a) Preposition (b) Conjunction
(c) Noun (d) Adverb
4. His explanation was quite detailed.
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Relative Pronoun (d) Preposition
5. He still lives in that house.
(a) Adverb (b) Adjective
(c) Preposition (d) Conjunction
6. Her courage impressed all crowd.
(a) Verb (b) Noun
(c) Adjective (d) Adverb
7. The actor appeared in a costly array.
(a) Noun (b) Verb
(c) Adverb (d) Adjective
8. Jacinta is very clever.
(a) Noun (b) Relative pronoun
(c) Adverb (d) Adjective

9. That is the least expensive option available.
(a) Adjective (b) Preposition
(c) Verb (d) Adverb
10. This is my friend who lives in Aizawl.
(a) Personal Pronoun (b) Indefinite Pronoun
(c) Demonstrative Pronoun (d) Reflexive pronoun

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 20): Correct usage & Vocabularies:

11. Where ignorance is bliss, it is folly to be wise. –
The figure of speech is-
(a) An irony (b) A metaphor
(c) An antithesis (d) A metonym
12. A word that has a different pronunciation and meaning from another word but has the same spelling is called-
(a) Synonym (b) Heterograph
(c) Homograph (d) Heteronym
13. The luxury yacht that we bought was nothing but a white elephant. The idiom 'white elephant' means
(a) An expensive thing (b) A costly and useful thing
(c) A cheap thing (d) A costly and useless thing
14. I tried reading a science journal but it was all greek to me. The idiom 'all greek to me' means-
(a) To be unintelligible (b) To understand everything
(c) To be enlightened (d) To be dumbfounded
15. Choose the sentence that accurately convey the meaning of the word – '**horde**'
(a) The picnic was interrupted by a horde of ants attracted to the sweet treats.
(b) She tends to horde food items in the pantry, fearing they will run out.
(c) He had a horde of comic books in his library.
(d) Ants are known to horde sweets like sugar and honey.
16. I have much _____ with you, my friend.
(a) compassion (b) pity
(c) sympathy (d) mercy
17. Cigarettes happen to be my father's _____.
(a) sin (b) crime
(c) custom (d) vice
18. Your homemade sauce _____ the steak perfectly.
(a) complement (b) compliment
(c) contrast (d) add
19. Mary _____ into the room, trying hard not to wake her roommates.
(a) scampered (b) crept
(c) accelerated (d) rushed

20. She was _____ at the sight of the accident.
(a) dismayed (b) discourage
(c) dismissed (d) dissuaded

Direction (Question Nos. 21 - 25): Choose the most suitable connector to complete the sentences:

21. I read all genres of books but I prefer thriller _____ romance.
(a) and (b) to
(c) with (d) than
22. _____ working as a nanny, she has been continuing with her studies.
(a) As a result of (b) Whereas
(c) However (d) In addition to
23. My friend came to my home _____ I was out.
(a) when (b) while
(c) after (d) before
24. _____ their years of hard work, they are finally able to buy a house.
(a) As a result of (b) In addition to
(c) Despite (d) Nevertheless
25. I must go home, or else my parents will be cross with me. The sentence connector here is –
(a) or else (b) will be
(c) must (d) The comma (,)

Direction (Question Nos. 26 - 30): Choose the appropriate prepositions:

26. She walked _____ the room.
(a) in (b) onto
(c) into (d) at
27. She was acquitted _____ all charges.
(a) of (b) on
(c) in (d) at
28. _____ studying John is also working somewhere.
(a) Beside (b) Besides
(c) Instead of (d) Over
29. A steady mind triumphs _____ difficulties.
(a) over (b) above
(c) in (d) on
30. Meena is very sparing _____ expenditure.
(a) at (b) on
(c) of (d) over

Direction (Question Nos. 31 - 35): Choose the appropriate adjectives to complete the sentences:

31. Jonathan is _____ of all the brothers
(a) charming (b) the most charming
(c) more charming (d) as charming as
32. The farmer said that there has not been _____ rain this year.
(a) significant (b) much
(c) sufficient (d) many
33. _____ food they had was damaged by the rain.
(a) A little (b) The little
(c) Little (d) Most
34. The Joker is often considered _____ villain.
(a) a madder (b) mad
(c) a madman (d) the maddest
35. The kind of adjective used in the sentence 'We have enough provisions to last a month' is :
(a) Adjective of Quantity (b) Adjective of Quality
(c) Adjective of Number (d) Demonstrative Adjective

Direction (Question Nos. 36 - 40): Choose the correct determiner:

36. A child usually has perfect trust in _____ parents.
(a) their (b) him
(c) its (d) her
37. I didn't take _____ vacations last year.
(a) much (b) many
(c) a (d) the
38. Mawia is _____ head of his family.
(a) the (b) a
(c) every (d) each
39. The prosecutors have _____ credible evidence to prove his guilt.
(a) All (b) Many
(c) Enough (d) The
40. _____ of us contributed 100 rupees to the Landslide Relief Fund.
(a) Each (b) Every
(c) Much (d) Enough

Direction (Question Nos. 41 - 45): Choose the correct sentence structure from the given options:

41.
(a) He showed many patience.
(b) He showed more patience.
(c) He showed much patience.
(d) He showed any patience.

42.

- (a) You are paying less attention to your studies than you used to do.
- (b) You pay less attention to your studies than you used to do.
- (c) You are paying less attention to your studies than you use to do.
- (d) You pay less attention to your studies than you use to do.

43.

- (a) EM Forster wrote in a passage to India.
- (b) EM Forster wrote a passage to India.
- (c) EM Forster wrote 'A Passage to India'.
- (d) EM Forster wrote in 'A Passage to India'.

44.

- (a) My birthday will fall on Sunday next year.
- (b) My birthday falls on Sunday next year.
- (c) My birthday will fall on a Sunday next year.
- (d) My birthday falls on a Sunday next year.

45.

- (a) Everyone must respect their superiors.
- (b) Everyone should respect their superiors.
- (c) Everyone should respect his superior.
- (d) Each one should respect his superior.

Direction (Question Nos. 46 - 50): Choose the correct type of clause for the words underlined in the given sentences:

46. As he worked hard, he requires a long rest.

- (a) Adjective clause
- (b) Adverb clause of reason
- (c) Noun clause
- (d) Adverb clause of time

47. He feared that he would fail.

- (a) Noun clause
- (b) Adjective clause
- (c) Adverb clause of time
- (d) Adverb clause of reason

48. You may sit where you like.

- (a) Noun clause
- (b) Adverb clause of place
- (c) Adverb clause of manner
- (d) Adverb clause of reason

49. How the budget got in is a mystery.

- (a) Adverb clause of manner
- (b) Noun clause
- (c) Adverb clause of time
- (d) Adjective clause

50. I know that Latin is no longer spoken as a native language.

- (a) Adjective clause
- (b) Adverb clause of reason
- (c) Noun clause
- (d) Adverb clause of time